# Nicole Esther Lee

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Dear Simular team,

My favourite part of any project is designing something, then making it real through code. I'm Nicole, and I'm studying for a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science in Interactive Media and Game Development at the Singapore Institute of Technology and DigiPen Institute of Technology. I'll be honest: programming isn't my strongest skill yet. That's where my bestie, AI, comes in. It helps me turn my wildest ideas into things that actually run, while I stay the one checking every decision.

Simular is betting that design, code and AI belong in the same room. So am I, so consider this me knocking on the door, even without a role posted that fits.

Here's what that looks like in practice:

- **My portfolio site.** I designed and built it with Claude Code: two versions, one design system. When the image viewer started to stutter, I didn't shrug it off. I profiled it and cut the average frame time from about 100 ms to 19 ms, because smooth is a feature.
- **Tick, a design system.** I let Figma's AI agent take the first pass, then went through its work like a teacher with a red pen, logging every defect with before-and-after evidence. AI does the volume; I check the decisions.
- **Friends Frog-ever.** For a school module, our team had to build a multi-platform 3D game on our own C++ engine. I built the whole Unity-style level editor on top of it, so our two design students could make a stealth game about a very determined frog, for Windows and Android, without touching engine code. My users weren't players. They were my teammates, and I designed for them the same way.
- **Chroma.** Another C++ engine module, this time a 2D puzzle game about paint. I joined as physics lead. When parts of the game stalled, I picked up the graphics, the level editor and the particle system too, and started organising everyone's tasks. By the end, my professor credited me as project manager. Lots of learning, slightly less sleep.

When an agent works on someone's computer, the hard part isn't the clicking. It's trust: showing what it's about to do and why, and keeping the person in control. I've designed for that before. In Polished by Pris, an app for a home nail studio, every AI suggestion shows why it appeared, and the owner always makes the final call. I'd love to bring that instinct, and the code to ship it, to Simular.

Right now I'm a Site Reliability Engineer intern at DBS Bank, automating operations and testing releases before they go live. It taught me that the best tools are the ones that quietly save someone an hour. Outside work, I co-run Kiko's Café, a small collectibles shop that grew on Instagram and Telegram, and I spend the rest of my time drawing, taking photos and playing piano.

I can start full-time from April 2027. You can see the work, and how I think through it, at nicoleesther.github.io/design. I'd love to chat, and I promise the portfolio has better pictures than this letter.

Thank you for reading,

Nicole Esther Lee